

technology domain but is massively expected to gain popularity and prominence in the coming few years because of increasing use-cases and global companies' focus to display innovative technologies via a partnership approach. Giant tech companies are also welcoming a hybrid strategy to leave their footprint on both hardware and software segments. They are buying startups and building their R&D to progress this technology more.

As VR popularity is increasing, shipments of headsets are speculated to escalate four times by the end of 2022. The software market is mainly centred on mobile device AR, which is equipped with SDK packages. Developers can now add AR capabilities to phone cameras, for example, and to apps such as Facebook and Snapchat.

To be able to scale and deploy VR training, a platform is needed that can carry out these functions, while also being able to integrate with existing systems. Apple's ARKit and Google's ARCore are both driving the mobile AR market.

Education and training are other major areas driving adoption in this segment. Apart from this, current developments in AR software platforms (for example, addition of vertical space detection in Apple's AR Kit) and upgraded development of application support have led to maturation of AR-enabled applications in smartphones.

Game engines like Unity and Unreal are critical to AR/VR development. They provide an expansive tool-set for developers to work with. Furthermore, Apple and Google have improved their AR-oriented developer libraries as well as allowed creation of never-seen-before AR experiences. **Research and Markets' new report predicts a market value of US\$ 38.7 billion for VR headsets by 2024.**

Conclusion

Technology has been going through a huge revolution for the past several years. VR and AR have been a huge part of this revolution. Emerging companies must keep in mind that, to succeed in the AR/VR market, adopting perfect strategy is the most important task because competition is increasing drastically.

In the last five years, the momentum of AR/VR market has been very active and, hence, scores of companies, both startups and MNCs, have rushed to develop this technology. Education and retail segments are now driving this market. Consumers will make the market bigger because prices are going down and the technology is maturing.

With current figures in hand, we can say that the AR/VR market has not yet reached its full potential. However, numbers definitely show a huge revolution in the industry. Several businesses are at the forefront of experimenting with AR/VR services and technologies to keep pace with growing customer interest. Emerging players in this segment will gain more opportunities from diverse demands of business customers. **EFY**

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